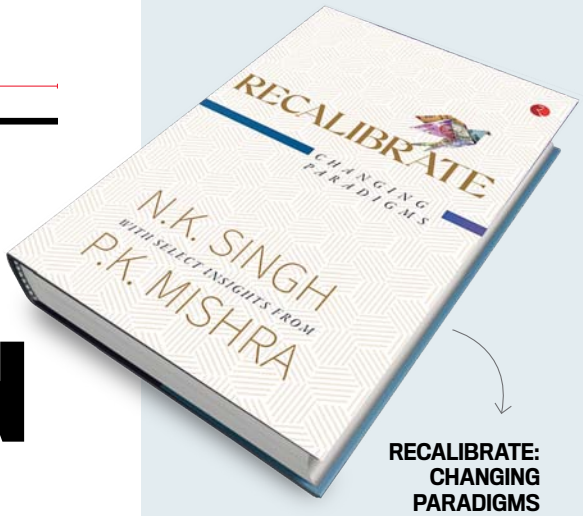
BOOKS

JUGALBANDI ON GOVERNANCE

By Raj Chengappa



RECALIBRATE: CHANGING PARADIGMS
by N.K. Singh, with select insights from P.K. Mishra
RUPA
₹**795; 344** pages

Both authors have dealt with power at intimate quarters and use their rich experience to provide fascinating anecdotes and insights into key issues and the reforms they need

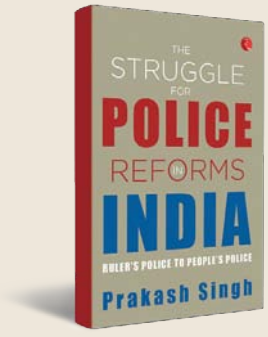
It is unusual for two distinguished former IAS officers with such vastly different experiences to combine forces and put down their learnings about governance. Lead author Nand Kishore Singh has worn several hats, the more recent one being chairman of the Fifteenth Finance Commission. A member of the Rajya Sabha earlier, he held several posts while in bureaucracy, among them being secretary to the prime minister and revenue secretary. Currently, he is president of the Institute of Economic Growth in Delhi. His co-author Pramod Kumar Mishra held several senior secretary-level posts both in the state and at the Centre, including being a Union Agriculture Secretary. Post retirement, he was first secretary to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and then from 2019 onwards his principal secretary.

Their book, titled *Recalibrate*, is a literary *jugalbandi* with an exceptional collection of insights on a range of subjects dealing with India's governance and development. With two Black Swan events in quick succession—the Covid pandemic and more recently Russia's invasion of Ukraine—causing tremendous global turbulence and uncertainty, nations including India need to recalibrate the way they governed themselves. The crux, as Singh points out in his opening essay, is the need for a new social contract between citizen and the state. The big challenge is to further human development and well-being even as the envelope of carbon space and natural resources begins to narrow.

Both authors have seen and dealt with power at intimate quarters and have been in the thick of major crises. They use their rich experience to provide fascinating personal anecdotes, comprehension of issues that matter and the reform needed. What makes the book stand out from other similar efforts is that the authors do not presume that the reader is well-versed

NATION BUILDING

Reforming India, one book at a time



THE STRUGGLE FOR POLICE REFORMS IN INDIA: Ruler's Police to People's Police
By Prakash Singh
RUPA,
426 pages,
₹**500**

A senior policeman recounts his quixotic legal crusade to instigate reforms for police efficiency—and to free the service from 'executive stranglehold'. Anecdotes from his eventful career include tangles with former home minister Charan Singh and the UP government's efforts to 'dilute' security arrangements around the Babri Masjid in 1992.

